IELTS ACADEMIC · RESTRICTED STAFF MATERIAL

IELTS Academic Set 33

PRIVATE STAFF answer key and Listening transcript

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Answer keys and Listening transcripts are restricted to staff.

Listening

Question	Answer	Accepted variants
1	Vair	
2	4200	4,200
3	side gate	
4	downpipe screen	
5	18 November	18th November, November 18, November 18th
6	photographic	
7	plant pots	
8	sediment depth	
9	garden pump	
10	kitchen tap	
11	B	
12	A	
13	C	
14	B	
15	A	
16	C	
17	F	
18	A	
19	E	

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Question	Answer	Accepted variants
20	B	
21	C	
22	A	
23	C	
24	B	
25	A	
26	E	
27	B	
28	D	
29	A	
30	F	
31	frequency sweep	
32	echo delay	
33	tragus	
34	wingbeat	
35	cluttered	
36	shorter	
37	vegetation gaps	
38	background echoes	
39	ear movement	
40	rapid updates	

Listening transcript

Part 1 - everyday social dialogue

Rory Fenlock	Good morning, ClearDrop inspections. I can arrange a routine visit and note anything the technician should know about access. First, could I take your surname?
Imogen Vair	It is Vair, V-A-I-R. The web enquiry changed it to Vale, so please make sure the booking says Vair.
Rory Fenlock	Certainly. What sort of tank do you have, and what capacity is shown on its label? An approximate figure is useful, but I will record the printed one.
Imogen Vair	It is a slimline tank behind the house. I thought it held four thousand litres, but the label actually says 4,200 litres.

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Rory Fenlock	Thank you. The technician brings a ladder and sampling bottle, so the route must be clear. Should the equipment come through the front or one of the gates?
Imogen Vair	The front path is too narrow and the back gate sticks. Please use the side gate; that gives the clearest route to the tank.
Rory Fenlock	And where is the inspection hatch in relation to the fittings? We need that detail so the technician approaches the correct side without moving anything unnecessarily.
Imogen Vair	The round hatch is on top, immediately beside the downpipe screen, not near the pump housing on the other side.
Rory Fenlock	Fine. I have morning appointments on the seventeenth and eighteenth of November. Is either date suitable, assuming arrival is before eleven?
Imogen Vair	Tuesday the seventeenth is impossible, but the next morning is ideal. Please book 18 November, before eleven if possible.
Rory Fenlock	That works. There is a short condition note, or a photographic report with labelled images and a diagram. Cleaning is quoted separately. Which report would you like?
Imogen Vair	The brief note would not be enough for the house file, so I will take the photographic report with the labelled images.
Rory Fenlock	Before the visit, leave the normal amount of water in the tank and clear the working area around the hatch. Is there anything there that you will need to move?
Imogen Vair	The ladder can stay where it is, but I need to move the plant pots. They are the only things blocking the working area.
Rory Fenlock	Good. The inspector will begin by measuring the sediment depth at the bottom. The screen check and water sample come afterwards, so the tank should not be emptied.
Imogen Vair	All right. I normally use an irrigation timer and a garden pump. Does either one need to be turned off before the inspector arrives?
Rory Fenlock	The timer can remain as it is, but please keep the garden pump switched off from breakfast until the inspection has finished.
Imogen Vair	Understood. For the water test, will the technician use the outdoor tank tap, or do you need a sample from inside the house?
Rory Fenlock	We need a household sample, so it will be taken from the kitchen tap, not the outdoor tank tap. The technician will call ten minutes before arrival.
Imogen Vair	That is clear. I will leave the tank at its normal level, move the pots and keep the pump off. Please email the summary so I can check the details.
Rory Fenlock	I will send it today with the appointment window and our direct number. If access changes, reply before the visit; any cleaning recommendation will come separately after inspection. Please read it carefully and tell us immediately if anything appears incorrect.

Part 2 - everyday social monologue

Ailsa Trenwith	Welcome to the Harbour Lantern Night Market induction. I am Ailsa, the site coordinator. Most arrangements are straightforward, but the waterfront lane is narrow, and a busy evening depends on everybody following the same sequence.

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Ailsa Trenwith	Your coloured pass shows an unloading time. Please keep to it, not because the pitch changes or the parking is cheaper, but because one shared lane must keep moving.
Ailsa Trenwith	Food and craft stalls use the same unloading entrance. Marshals will direct vans forward; reversing is allowed only when a marshal signals. After unloading, vehicles move to the remote car park, leaving fire access clear.
Ailsa Trenwith	At the power desk, staff do not count appliances or judge cable colour. They check that each powered item carries a current power tag before it is connected.
Ailsa Trenwith	Hygiene controls are divided by task. Hand-washing units are for vendors handling food. Drinking-water taps are marked blue, and cleaning water is collected separately. These are practical site arrangements rather than optional conveniences.
Ailsa Trenwith	The grey station is for tied bags of general non-food rubbish. Cardboard goes to the reuse cage, while cooking oil has its own sealed return point.
Ailsa Trenwith	Power is supplied from covered distribution boxes. Domestic multi-plugs are not accepted. If you have no electrical equipment, you still pass the desk so staff can mark that status on the site list.
Ailsa Trenwith	At nine forty-five we begin the quiet close. Trading continues for fifteen minutes, but amplified music stops so nearby residents are not disturbed.
Ailsa Trenwith	Waste becomes busiest near closing. Separate bins reduce spills and let the cleaning crew work without crossing the customer queue. A steward can show you the station, but cannot carry hot oil from a stall.
Ailsa Trenwith	A vehicle pass only admits you to unloading, and prices are your responsibility. The laminated stall permit must remain visible throughout the evening.
Ailsa Trenwith	For departure, keep products on display until ten. Pack inside your pitch first, then fetch your vehicle when your row is called. That staged exit is quieter and leaves the emergency lane usable.
Ailsa Trenwith	Once unloaded, collapse empty delivery crates and take them back to the loading bay. Do not leave them behind your stall.
Ailsa Trenwith	If an extension lead is split or its tag cannot be read, carry it unplugged to the power desk and report it there.
Ailsa Trenwith	Tie ordinary rubbish securely. Those bags belong at the grey waste station, not at the cardboard cage beside it.
Ailsa Trenwith	Let used oil cool in its original covered container. Return it only at the oil return point after the dinner rush.
Ailsa Trenwith	If wind damages your permit or you misplace it, the permit office can verify your booking and print a replacement.

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Ailsa Trenwith	Stall lighting may be switched on after the power check, but decorative lights must stay within the pitch. Battery lights are acceptable if they are stable and do not obstruct the public aisle. Gas equipment is handled under a separate safety briefing. During trading, keep stock boxes under the table rather than in the lane. A market steward may ask you to move an item even if it fitted during setup, because customer flow changes after dark. The first-aid point is near the permit office, while lost property goes to the information tent. Those facilities are not part of the matching task, but you should know them before customers arrive. At closing, do not begin vehicle loading until your row number is announced. This avoids a queue across the pedestrian exit.
Ailsa Trenwith	Please ask location questions now. Individual trading advice can be discussed with the permit team after this shared briefing.

Part 3 - educational/training discussion

Finlay Rusk	Marta, the tutor liked our question about habitat, but asked whether our method separates habitat effects from conditions on the sampling day. We need a design another group could repeat, not simply a longer species list.
Marta Keir	Our first plan compares the woodland and sports field as if habitat is the only difference, but the woodland plots are much wetter. Soil moisture could explain a count difference.
Finlay Rusk	The campus has six potential plots in each habitat. Random selection sounds attractive, but a completely random draw could give us all wet woodland plots and all dry grass plots. A blocking variable would make the comparison more informative.
Marta Keir	I considered hand sorting alone, yet effort would vary. We should retain mustard extraction because we can apply the same concentration, area and waiting time at every plot.
Finlay Rusk	We also need one defined sampling quadrat. Enlarging it would produce more organisms but would not remove bias. Replicating several modest quadrats is preferable because one unusually rich patch will not dominate the whole result.
Marta Keir	For observer bias, swapping guides will not help. The same pair of people should sort every sample, then resolve disagreements together.
Finlay Rusk	Extraction choice matters because methods sample behaviour as well as abundance. Our report should say that clearly. We are not claiming one method captures every earthworm equally; we are keeping effort repeatable for this comparison.
Marta Keir	Before any solution is poured, we will record soil moisture. Worm length and vegetation height can be secondary, but moisture must come first.
Marta Keir	Let us allocate tasks without creating different procedures. I can prepare coded sample bags and the moisture probe. Finlay can mark coordinates, but we will both do the sorting so the decision rule stays constant.
Finlay Rusk	So the primary comparison will use paired moist plots, one in each habitat. Total habitat counts and time-of-day patterns can remain exploratory.
Marta Keir	The data sheet needs zeroes as well as positive counts. A blank cell might mean nobody looked. A recorded zero means the method was completed and no worm emerged during the timed interval.
Finlay Rusk	Recent rainfall creates unequal moisture. Pairing plots by their measured moisture is the revision that addresses that problem.

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Marta Keir	Finally, the report should distinguish observations from interpretation. Moisture, counts and photographs are observations. Any explanation about habitat quality comes later and must acknowledge weather and limited sample size.
Finlay Rusk	If one team waits five minutes and another waits ten, effort changes. We will standardise extraction time with a single timer.
Marta Keir	Juvenile worms are hard to identify consistently. A shared identification check by both students should reduce disagreement.
Finlay Rusk	When a specimen remains uncertain, we will photograph it against a scale and confirm it later rather than inventing a species label.
Marta Keir	To prevent trampling from changing the surface, we will measure each quadrat before sampling and approach from the marked path.
Finlay Rusk	We also need a rule for weather interruption. If rain begins after the first quadrat, we should finish that paired plot but not start a new pair under different conditions. The sheet can mark the interruption rather than hiding it. Replication must be balanced across the two habitats: three paired plots on the first morning and three on the second, with the order alternated. That prevents one habitat always being sampled after the sun has warmed the soil. For specimen handling, adults can be grouped provisionally in the field, but final labels are assigned only after the shared check. Juveniles remain in a separate category because forcing a species name would create false precision. We should return organisms near the sampling point after identification, following the approved field procedure. The report will describe that handling without claiming the method is harmless in every circumstance. Finally, raw photographs should use coded plot numbers, not student names, so the archive can be checked by the tutor without exposing unnecessary personal information.
Marta Keir	We can now rewrite the methods section and bring the paired-plot plan to the tutor tomorrow.

Part 4 - academic monologue

Lecturer	Today we move from the basic idea of echolocation to a harder environment: flight among vegetation. The important point is not that clutter has one universal definition. Researchers can measure it in several ways, and each measure captures a different aspect of spatial complexity.
Lecturer	Many bats emit a downward frequency sweep, so a single brief call carries a broad range of frequencies rather than one unchanging note.
Lecturer	A call begins as a pressure wave produced in the vocal system. After it leaves the bat, surfaces reflect some energy. The animal does not receive a labelled message; its nervous system must compare timing, frequency and intensity across rapidly changing echoes.
Lecturer	The simplest ranging cue is echo delay: the interval between the outgoing call and its return increases with target distance.
Lecturer	Frequency matters because a broad signal can provide fine information about a target. Yet high frequencies also lose energy quickly in air. A bat therefore balances detail against range, and the balance changes as it moves from open space towards leaves.
Lecturer	In the outer ear, a small projection called the tragus contributes cues that help the auditory system analyse returning sound.

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Lecturer	Timing is equally important. If a new call is made before the previous echoes have been processed, signals may overlap. Close to an obstacle, shorter intervals update the scene rapidly; farther away, longer intervals leave time for distant returns.
Lecturer	During flight, call production may be coordinated with each wingbeat, which can reduce the energetic cost of breathing and calling.
Lecturer	The ears are not passive funnels. Their shape affects how sound reaches the eardrum, and movements can alter the reception pattern. This contributes to localisation, especially when the animal changes direction between one call and the next.
Lecturer	Branches and leaves make what researchers call a cluttered habitat, where echoes arrive from many surfaces in very quick succession.
Lecturer	Now consider prey capture. A small insect may return a weak echo while a broad leaf sends back a strong one. Differences in movement and acoustic texture can help, but the task becomes more demanding when wind moves the vegetation too.
Lecturer	When a bat approaches vegetation, shorter calls reduce overlap between an outgoing signal and the earliest returning echoes.
Lecturer	Field studies connect call behaviour with mapped habitat. Some count openings, some estimate the distance to the nearest vegetation, and others reconstruct three-dimensional structure. Results should be interpreted in relation to the chosen clutter measure.
Lecturer	One practical clutter measure is to count vegetation gaps along a defined line, although other optical and spatial measures are possible.
Lecturer	The ecological conclusion is therefore a trade-off, not a perfect solution. Signals adapted for rapid close-range decisions may not travel far. Signals that reach farther may provide updates too slowly for dense branches. Bats adjust rather than use one fixed call.
Lecturer	To detect an insect near foliage, the bat must separate the prey echo from strong background echoes returned by leaves and stems.
Lecturer	Small ear movement can change the direction from which sound is received most strongly, adding dynamic information during approach.
Lecturer	In dense vegetation, the chief benefit of brief calls is rapid updates about nearby obstacles. Their lower energy can shorten range, but that is a cost rather than the benefit.
Lecturer	Call shape also reflects the task. During search, a bat may leave longer gaps and listen over a broader area. During approach, calls become more frequent as distance closes. This sequence gives researchers behavioural phases, but boundaries are gradual rather than perfectly discrete. Microphones introduce their own sampling limits. A detector placed beside a path may record bats that use open gaps more readily than individuals moving deep within foliage. Comparing call counts without considering placement could therefore exaggerate one strategy. Researchers sometimes pair acoustic recordings with thermal cameras or small movement tags. Each instrument adds information but also changes the sample: tags can be attached only to captured animals, while cameras cover a limited field of view. The term clutter should consequently be operational. Counting gaps, estimating nearest-obstacle distance and measuring vegetation density are related approaches, not interchangeable numbers. When a study reports an association between one measure and call duration, the result belongs to that defined measure and setting. This caution does not weaken the research; it makes comparisons reproducible. Echolocation is impressive precisely because the animal integrates incomplete echoes while moving in real time, not because every echo yields an exact three-dimensional map.

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Lecturer	In the next lecture we will compare these acoustic strategies with vision and touch during the final stage of prey capture.

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Reading

Question	Answer	Accepted variants
1	dispatch station	
2	pressure fan	
3	switch junction	
4	receiving terminal	
5	return line	
6	inspection access	
7	G	
8	C	
9	F	
10	E	
11	A	
12	H	
13	D	
14	FALSE	
15	TRUE	
16	FALSE	
17	TRUE	
18	NOT GIVEN	
19	TRUE	
20	NOT GIVEN	
21	habitat	
22	outside surface	
23	controlled passage	
24	night lighting	
25	fixed route	
26	local context	
27	YES	
28	NO	

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Question	Answer	Accepted variants
29	YES	
30	NO	
31	NOT GIVEN	
32	B	
33	C	
34	A	
35	D	
36	C	
37	F	
38	A	
39	E	
40	B	

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